continuation of intelligence gathering, and took decisions regarding issues of prevention.

As discussed, the Iraqi reactor Osirak was bombed and destroyed on June 7, 1981, though the working assumption of those involved was that Saddam Hussein would not simply give up but would continue to pursue military nuclear capability. In the mid-1980s, we received information about the possibility of the renewal of French-Iraqi nuclear cooperation. Around the same time, news came in from Iraq regarding the establishment of centrifuges for enriching uranium, with the help of Pakistan and trained Iraqi scientists. One of the stunning successes of our prevention efforts was the transfer of information to two European countries regarding special material intended for the manufacture of centrifuges, produced in a European country, which was secretly transferred to a neighboring country and loaded onto an Iraqi commercial plane. The plane, along with its cargo and personnel, was stopped by the local authorities. It wasn't easy to convince the European parties to lend their hand to this complex operation. They gave their consent only after we presented them with unequivocal evidence that the material in question had no industrial or scientific use other than centrifuges for uranium enrichment.

Beyond the megalomania inherent in Saddam Hussein's personality, the Iraqi efforts to acquire surface-to-surface missile capabilities at the beginning of the 1980s stemmed from Iraq's relative inferiority in this area as compared to Iran. The Scud B missile that the Soviets had provided to Iraq had a limited range of only three hundred kilometers, which did not satisfy Saddam, and in 1982 he made intensive efforts to acquire an arsenal of surface-to-surface missiles with a variety of ranges, including missiles armed with medium- and long-range nuclear warheads. The "Al-Hussein" missile developed by the Iraqis was based on the original Scud, but its range was twice as long; this doubling of range to six hundred kilometers was made possible by reducing the weight of the explosive from 1,000 kilos to only 250 kilos. The result was a primitive missile with a primitive guidance system and a high chance of burning upon its return into the atmosphere, that is, before hitting its target. Still, despite these technological limitations, thirty-nine Al-Hussein missiles were launched from Iraq and landed in Israel during the First Gulf War (January–February 1990).